

WHAT IS

DISCOVERY?

Talk. Listen. Understand.
Then solve.

THE CORE IDEA

Discovery is the work you do before designing a solution.

Understand the customer's reality before you decide what to build.

01

CONTEXT

02

CURRENT STATE

03

FRICTION

04

IMPACT

05

CONSTRAINTS

06

SUCCESS

CUSTOMER FIRST

Strong technology work does not begin with a feature, demo, or AI idea.

It begins by listening.

The Discovery mindset

Your strongest advantage is curiosity.

01

BE CURIOUS

Ask because you genuinely want to understand—not because you are waiting to pitch.

02

STAY SOLUTION-NEUTRAL

Do not assume the answer is AI, an agent, an app, or a specific technology.

03

LISTEN FOR EVIDENCE

Look for examples, repeated pain points, workarounds, delays, risks, and consequences.

04

GO ONE LEVEL DEEPER

The first answer may describe a symptom. Follow-up questions reveal the underlying problem.

05

CHALLENGE ASSUMPTIONS

Separate what your team believes from what the customer actually said.

06

CAPTURE INSIGHTS

Write down who is affected, what happens, why it matters, and what success looks like.

YOUR JOB

Do not walk in trying to prove your idea. Walk in trying to understand the customer.

Ask questions that open the conversation

Open-ended questions create stories, context, and evidence—not one-word answers.

DON'T LEAD

“Is this process difficult?”

ASK INSTEAD

“What is the most difficult part of this process today?”

DON'T ASSUME

“Would automation help?”

ASK INSTEAD

“Which parts require the most manual effort, and why?”

DON'T PITCH

“Would you use an AI agent?”

ASK INSTEAD

“If you could improve one part of this experience, what would you change?”

FOLLOW THE INTERESTING ANSWERS

→ Can you tell me more?

→ Can you give us an example?

→ Why does that happen?

→ What happens next?

→ Who is most affected?

→ How do you handle it today?

→ How often does it happen?

→ What would change if it disappeared?

LISTEN > TALK

Discovery should feel more like an interview than a presentation.

Your Discovery conversation

A simple flow to move from context to a meaningful problem.

01

CONTEXT

Who are we speaking with? What is their role? Who else is involved?

02

CURRENT STATE

Walk us through how the work happens today, from beginning to end.

03

FRICTION

Where does the process slow down, become repetitive, confusing, risky, or frustrating?

04

IMPACT

What happens because of that problem? Who is affected? How often?

05

CONSTRAINTS

What data, policies, security requirements, dependencies, or limitations matter?

06

SUCCESS

If this worked significantly better, what would success look like?

REMEMBER

The goal is not to collect questions. The goal is to understand the problem.

What should you listen for?

PAIN

Frustration, delays, errors, duplicated work.

WORKAROUNDS

Manual handoffs, spreadsheets, repeated copy/paste, side processes.

IMPACT

Lost time, poor experience, risk, cost, missed opportunity.

CONSTRAINTS

Security, data access, compliance, integrations, timing.

PEOPLE

Who experiences the issue and who influences the solution.

SUCCESS

What outcome the customer actually values.

DO NOT LEAVE WITH A FEATURE LIST.

Leave understanding the problem, its impact, and the evidence behind it.

READY TO MOVE FORWARD?

Discovery → Strategize

Before you move on, your team should be able to answer:

- ✓ Who is experiencing the problem?
- ✓ What is happening today?
- ✓ What friction did you discover?
- ✓ Why does the problem matter?
- ✓ What evidence or examples did you hear?
- ✓ What constraints must a solution respect?
- ✓ What would a successful outcome look like?

YOUR DISCOVERY OUTPUT

PROBLEM INSIGHT

[Stakeholder/user] experiences [specific problem] during [context/process], which creates [impact].

During discovery, we heard [evidence/example]. A better outcome would be [desired result].

The quality of your solution depends on
the quality of your understanding.